THE WAR MAPS PROJECT / CURRENT FIELD PROOF

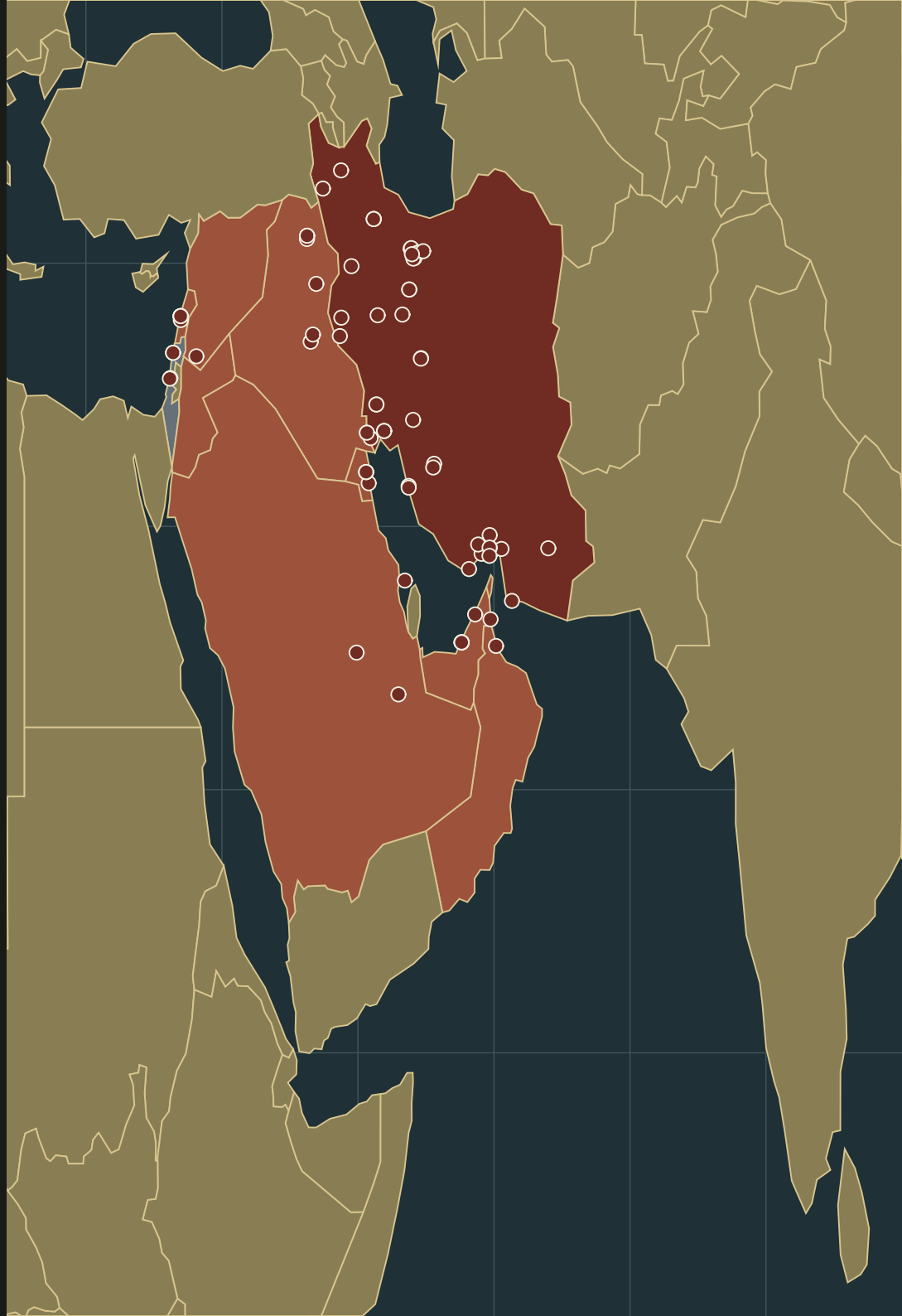
The Iran War Map

The unresolved regional event field

2026-02-28 - 2026-08-31

126 candidate events connected to their recorded locales. The field remains unresolved beyond the source boundary.

UCDP CANDIDATE CONFLICT 16905 / STATE-BASED / OPEN AT SOURCE BOUNDARY



CURRENT WAR / UNRESOLVED OUTCOME

No retrospective turning point yet

The historical War Map rule selects a movement visible before eventual victory. A current conflict has no such hindsight. This proof therefore maps the complete observed candidate-event interval without predicting its endpoint.

CURRENT-FIELD RULE

Begin at the first observed departure. End at the latest source observation. Keep the frontier open.

The map does not borrow certainty from a future outcome. It retains the event field, recorded parties, locations, casualties, source status, and unanswered causal structure available now.

The source currently begins on 2026-02-28 and contains events through 2026-08-31. The project date is later than the observation boundary; the missing interval remains missing.

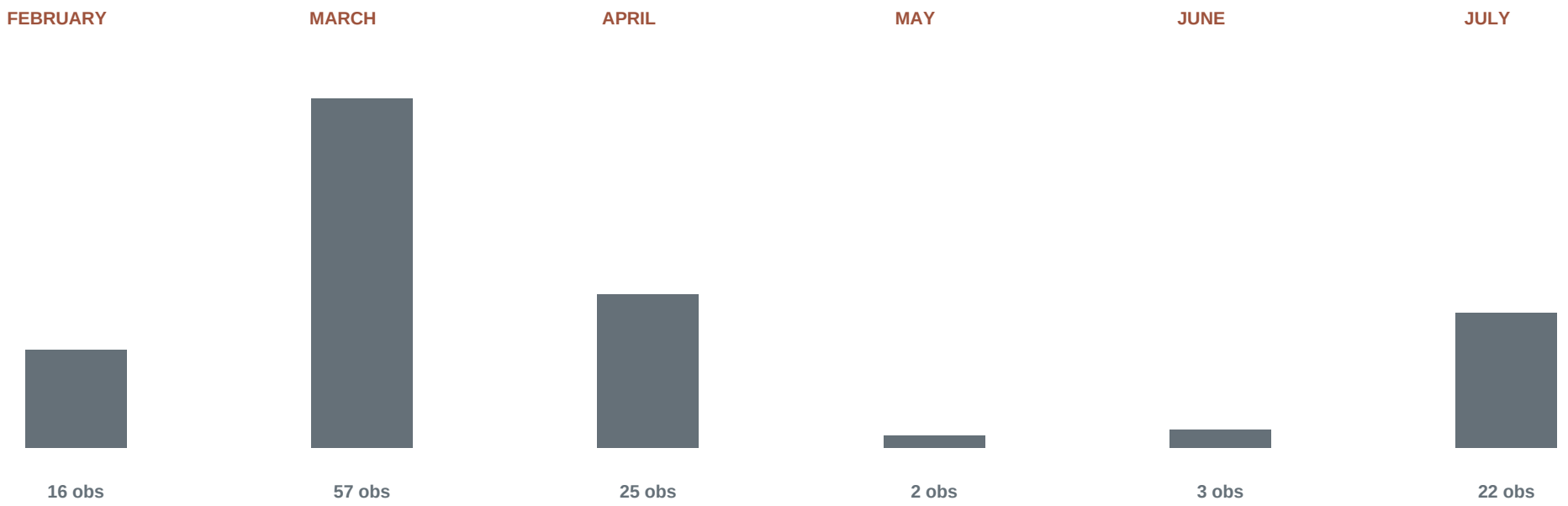
SELECTION STATEMENT

This current-war proof cannot identify a retrospectively decisive movement because the outcome is unresolved. It therefore encloses the complete observed candidate-event interval and treats 28 February only as the opening departure in the loaded record. The frame ends at the latest observed event, not at the present and not at a conflict endpoint.

CANDIDATE-EVENT ACCUMULATION

The field develops by month

Counts show observations in the loaded candidate-event snapshots. Casualty estimates remain attached to individual records because candidate observations can overlap.



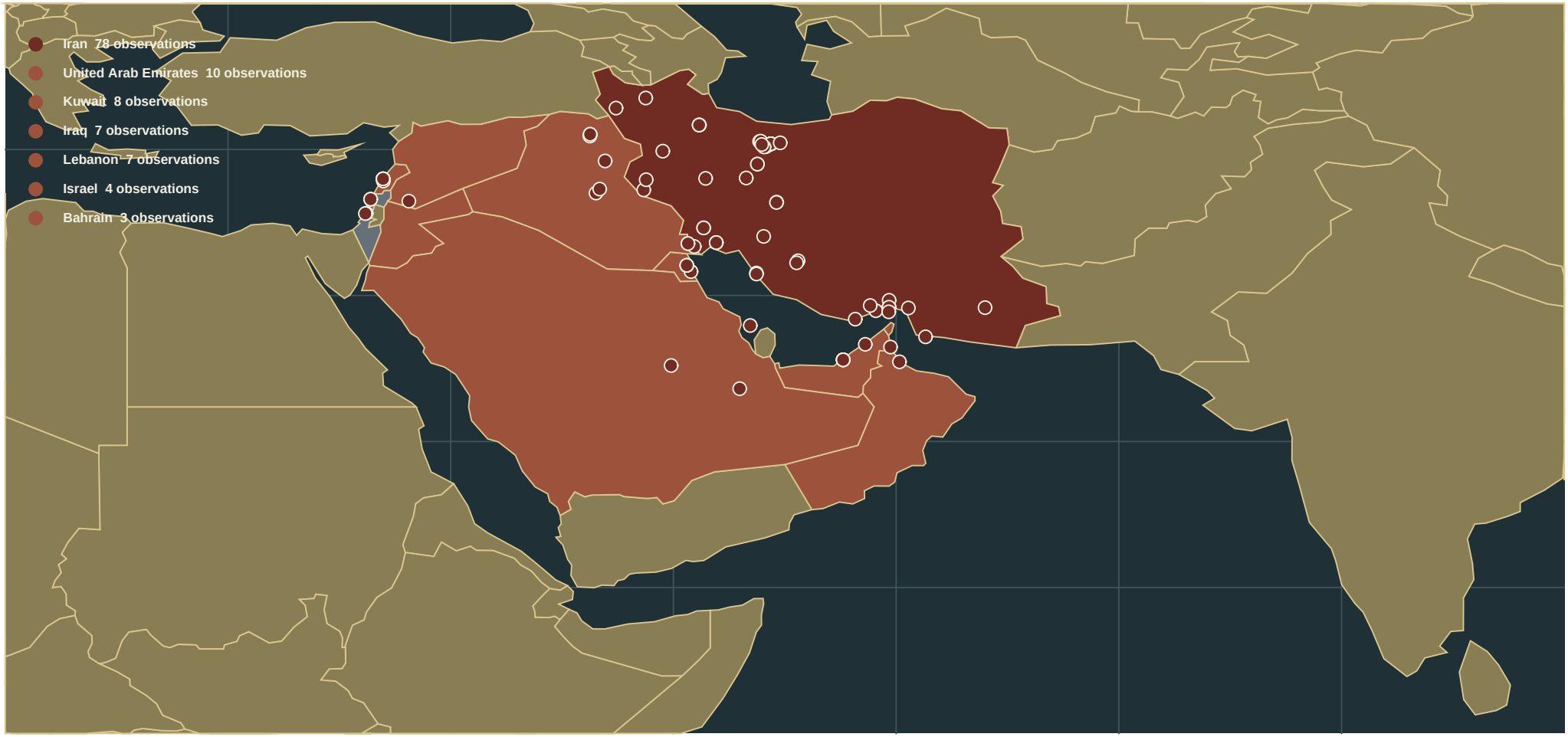
READING THE INTERVAL

The opening month contains the largest number of candidate observations and the beginning of the multi-locale structure. Later observations extend the temporal enclosure; they do not retroactively establish an eventual winner or decisive movement.

ELIGIBLE EVENT COORDINATES

One conflict, a provisional event field

The formal UCDP dyad occupies a wider geographic event surface. Equal-area circles are candidate observations with eligible point geometry; country fill identifies recorded terrestrial locale, not belligerent membership.



BOUNDARY

Natural Earth supplies reference geometry. UCDP supplies event coordinates, location precision, status, parties, and fatality ranges. Precision 5-6 and Check geography records are withheld from the point layer; maritime observations use separate network locales.

LOCALE PROPORTIONALITY

Where candidate observations accumulate

Event share uses the loaded conflict network as its denominator. It describes source-record density, not attack direction, casualties, or a complete regional war ledger.

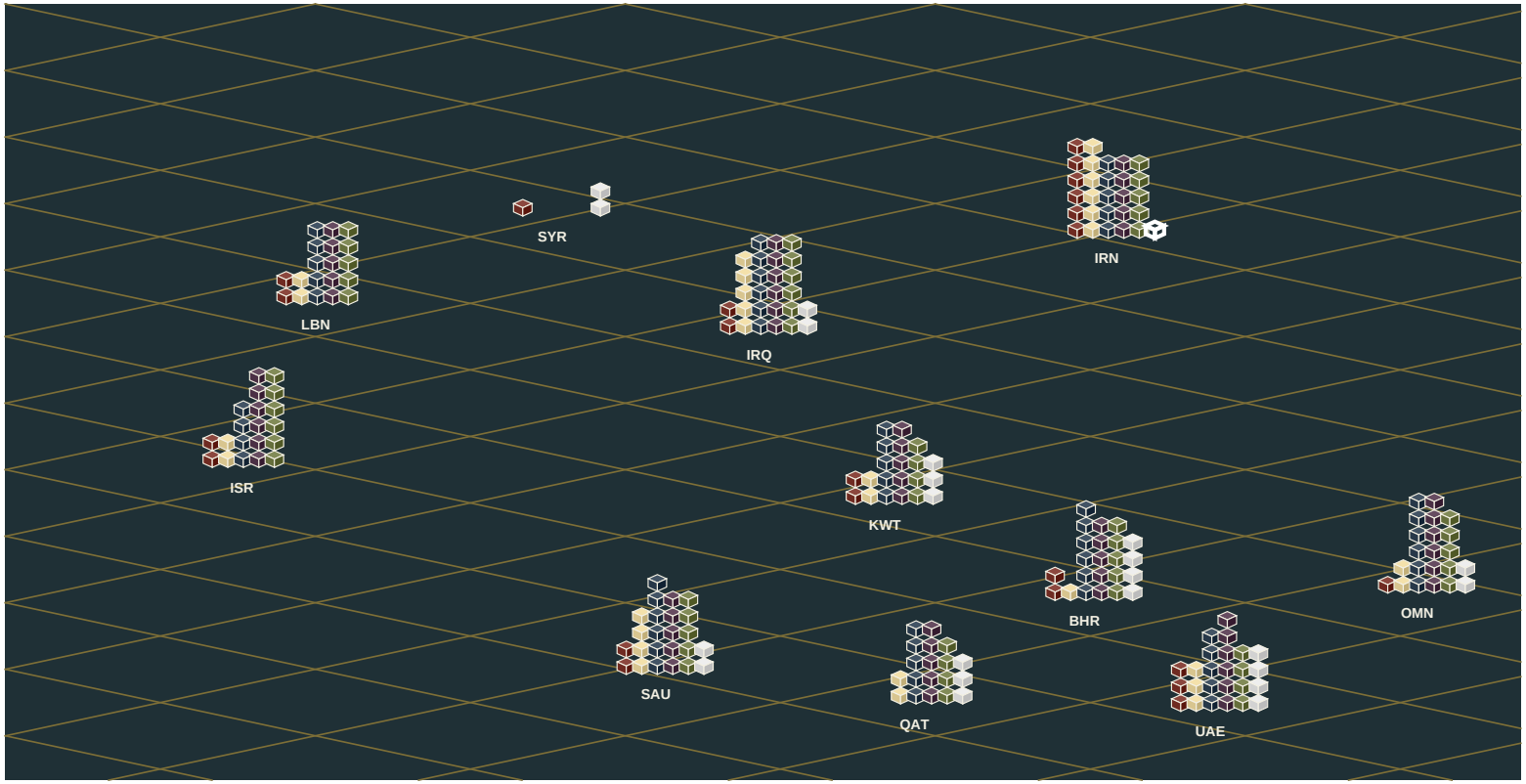
RECORDED LOCALE		OBSERVATION SHARE	CASUALTY ROLL-UP
Iran	78/126	61.9%	not computed / possible overlap
United Arab Emirates	10/126	7.9%	not computed / possible overlap
Kuwait	8/126	6.3%	not computed / possible overlap
Iraq	7/126	5.6%	not computed / possible overlap
Lebanon	7/126	5.6%	not computed / possible overlap
Israel	4/126	3.2%	not computed / possible overlap
Bahrain	3/126	2.4%	not computed / possible overlap
Saudi Arabia	3/126	2.4%	not computed / possible overlap
Strait of Hormuz	2/126	1.6%	not computed / possible overlap
Jordan	1/126	0.8%	not computed / possible overlap
Maritime area near Sri Lanka	1/126	0.8%	not computed / possible overlap
Oman	1/126	0.8%	not computed / possible overlap
Syria	1/126	0.8%	not computed / possible overlap

GCC VULNERABILITY FIELD 25/126 observations (19.8%) / CASUALTY ROLL-UP NOT COMPUTED

ISOMETRIC REGIONAL COMPARISON

Relative stacks across the vulnerability field

Each metric forms a separate stack at every observed locale. Stack height is normalized within that metric and carries no shared vertical unit. The basing-context stack is ordinal only and does not represent installation or troop counts.



STACK KEY

- Conflict observations
- Population
- Mortality
- Fertility
- Crude birth rate

U.S. basing context

BASING STACK

Relative relationship class only. White outline marks former-only footprint. No printed number is implied.

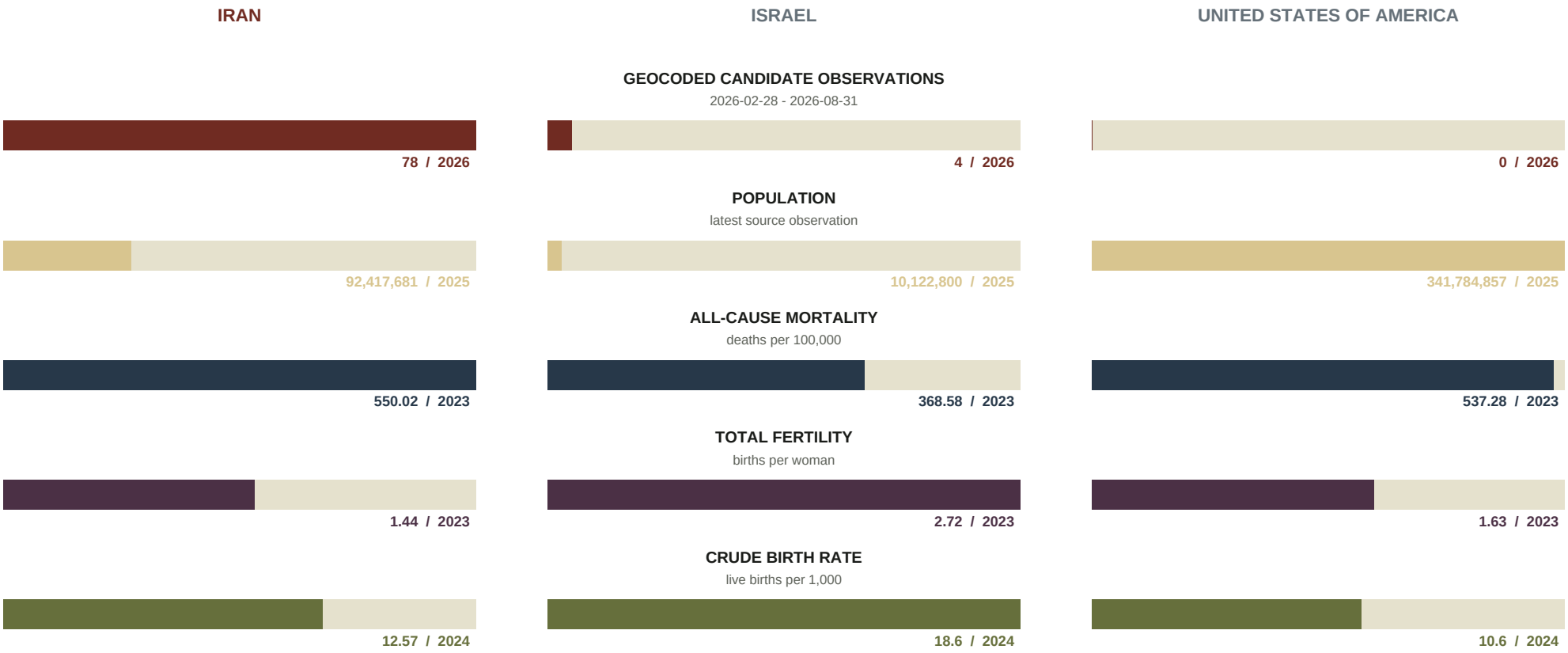
Independent scales preserve visual comparison without adding unlike measures. Close locales are offset for legibility. QAT is strategic context outside the 12 UCDP event locales; its conflict stack is absent.

Source years remain those printed on the following precise comparison page.

CONFLICT PERIOD / LATEST AVAILABLE CONTEXT

The war inside unequal living fields

Conflict values count candidate observations geocoded to each state during the observed interval. Population-health sources end before 2026, so their latest observations are shown with their actual years rather than projected into the conflict date.



DO NOT MERGE THE SCALES

Candidate observations can overlap and are not added into casualty totals. Population is a count; mortality is a rate; fertility and crude birth rate are distinct birth measures. Bar length compares countries within one row only.

UCDP SIDE A

Iran

Party role, event-location exposure, and population-health context remain separate. Event counts below mean records geocoded to this state, not a complete measure of attacks conducted, forces deployed, or national deaths.

SIDE A / CANDIDATE LAYER

78 observations

V-DEM 2025

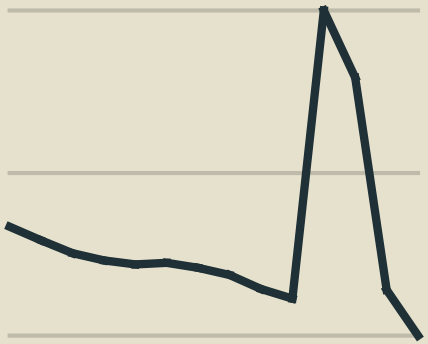
Electoral autocracy

EVENT-LOCATION BOUNDARY

78 candidate observations are coded to this territory. Casualty totals are not computed because records may overlap.

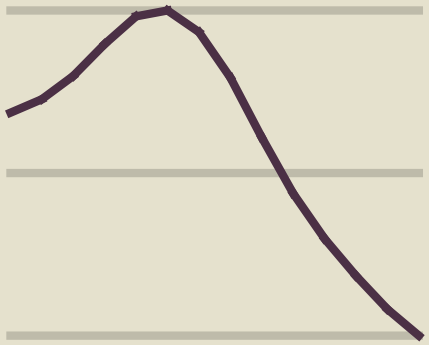
ALL-CAUSE MORTALITY

835.7 to 550.0 per 100k



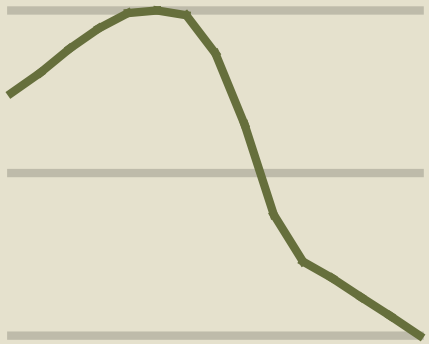
TOTAL FERTILITY

2.0 to 1.4 births/woman



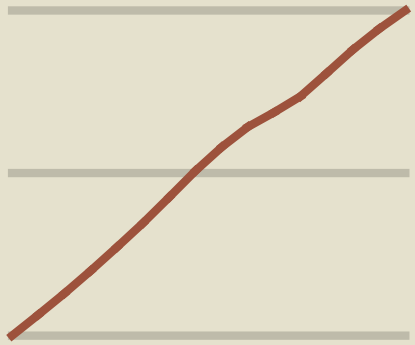
CRUDE BIRTH RATE

18.9 to 12.6 per 1,000



POPULATION

92,417,681.0 to 77,420,842.0 people



UCDP SIDE B

Israel

Party role, event-location exposure, and population-health context remain separate. Event counts below mean records geocoded to this state, not a complete measure of attacks conducted, forces deployed, or national deaths.

SIDE B / CANDIDATE LAYER

4 observations

V-DEM 2025

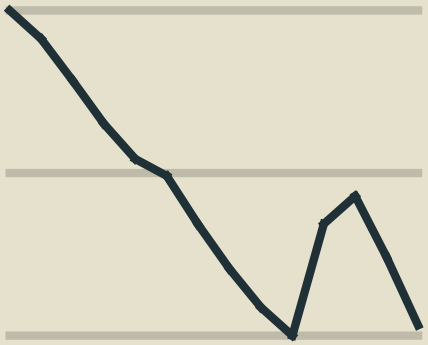
Electoral democracy

EVENT-LOCATION BOUNDARY

4 candidate observations are coded to this territory. Casualty totals are not computed because records may overlap.

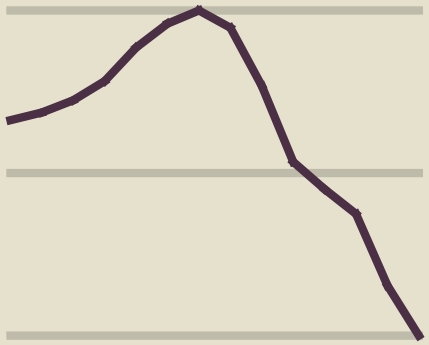
ALL-CAUSE MORTALITY

421.2 to 366.9 per 100k



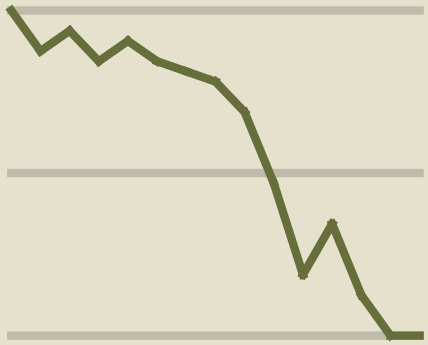
TOTAL FERTILITY

3.0 to 2.7 births/woman



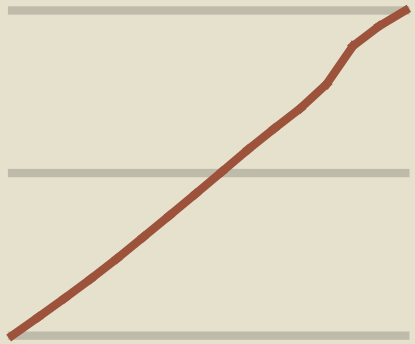
CRUDE BIRTH RATE

21.8 to 18.6 per 1,000



POPULATION

10,122,800.0 to 7,623,600.0 people



UCDP SIDE B

United States of America

Party role, event-location exposure, and population-health context remain separate. Event counts below mean records geocoded to this state, not a complete measure of attacks conducted, forces deployed, or national deaths.

SIDE B / CANDIDATE LAYER

0 observations

V-DEM 2025

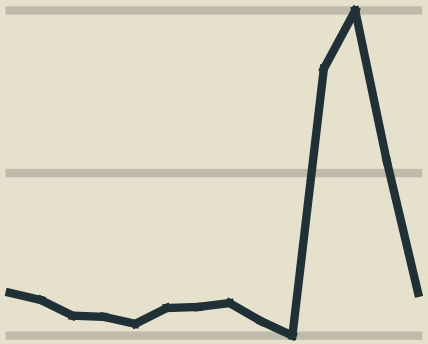
Electoral democracy

EVENT-LOCATION BOUNDARY

No event location in the loaded interval.

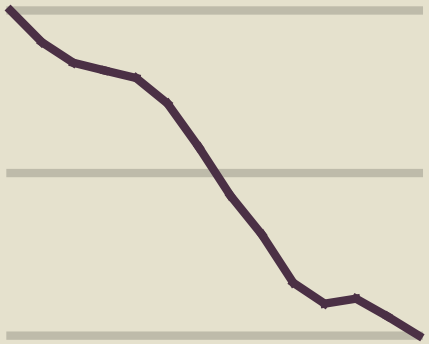
ALL-CAUSE MORTALITY

628.2 to 523.5 per 100k



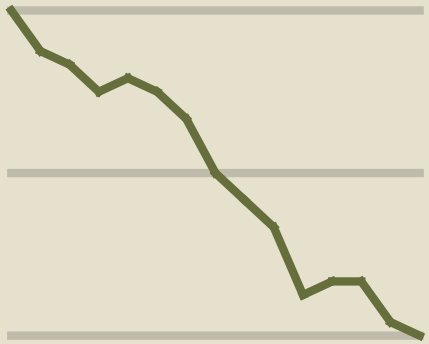
TOTAL FERTILITY

1.9 to 1.6 births/woman



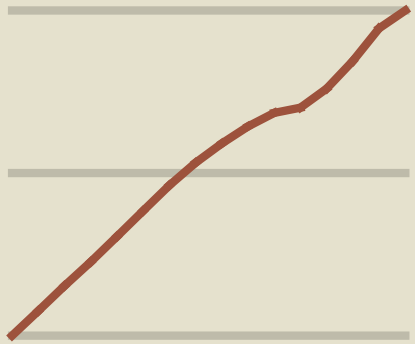
CRUDE BIRTH RATE

13.0 to 10.6 per 1,000



POPULATION

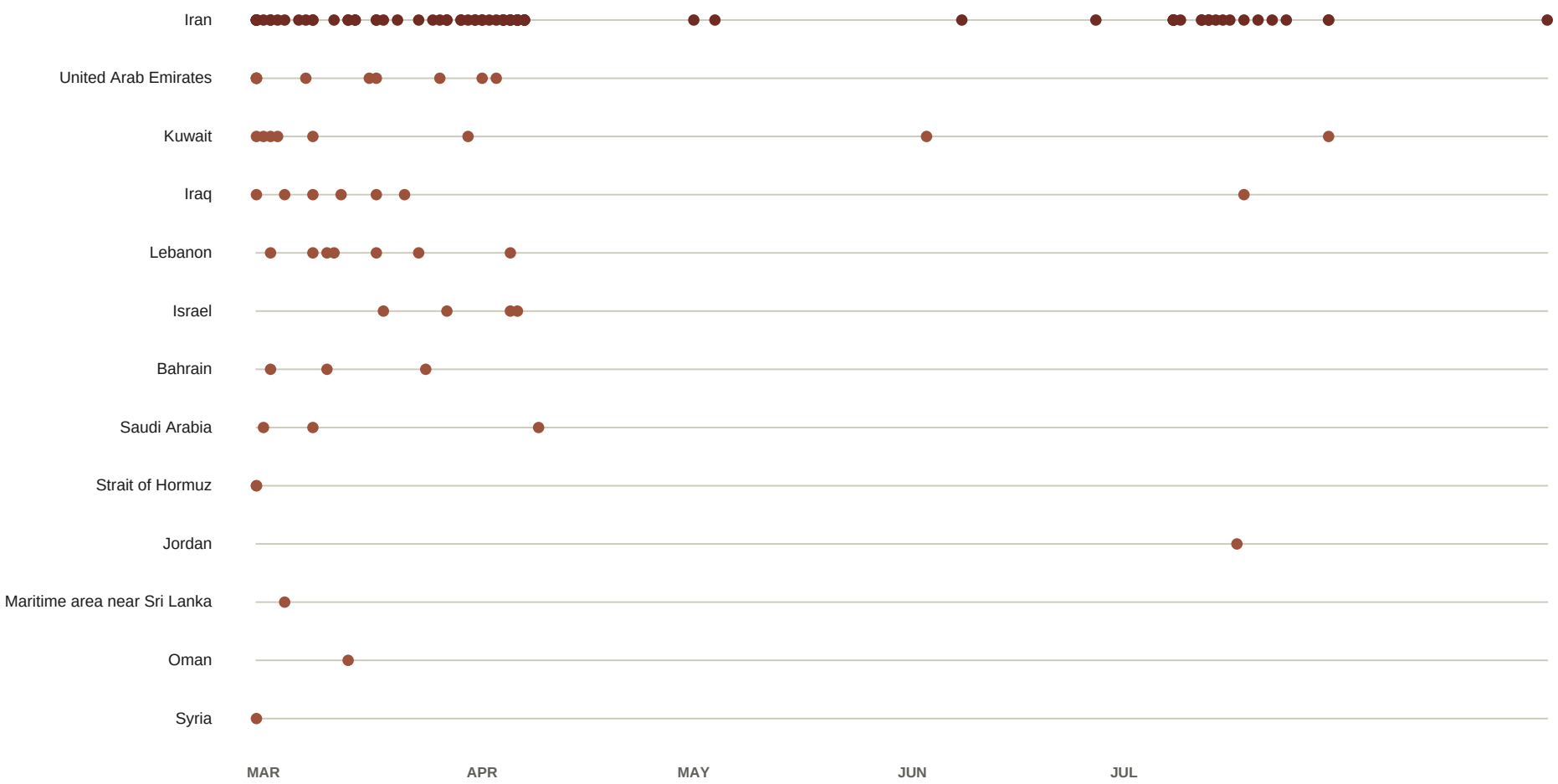
341,784,857.0 to 309,378,227.0 people



EVENT SEQUENCE BY LOCALE

The regional surface appears immediately

Every equal-area mark is one candidate observation positioned by start date and grouped vertically by recorded locale. Blank periods remain blank.



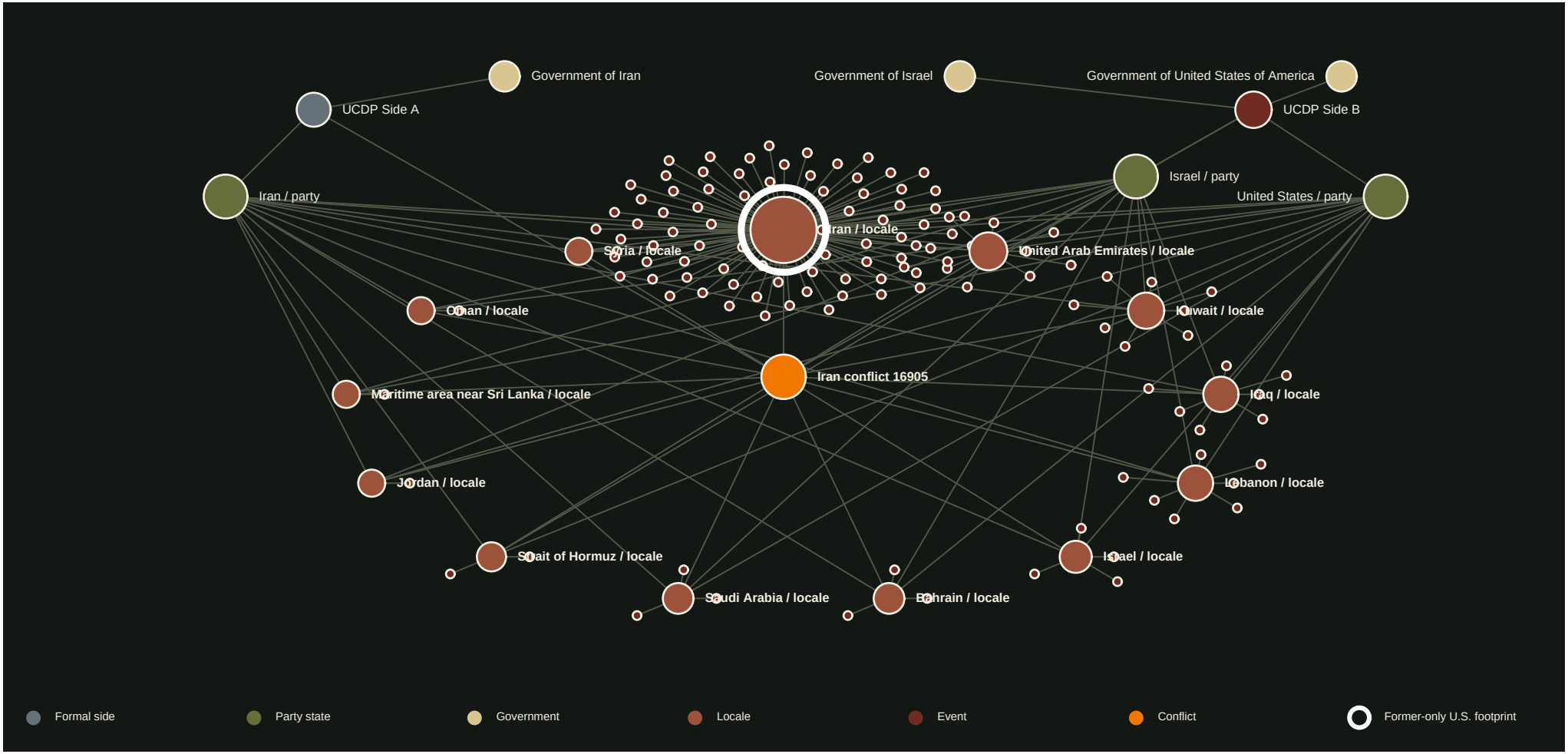
INTERPRETIVE FRONTIER

Temporal sequence can test retaliation and escalation accounts, but direction must be read from event-level actor and source records rather than inferred from locale alone.

WEBSITE TOPOLOGY / PRINT FIELD

Parties, vulnerability field, locales, events

The formal dyad remains at the core. GCC countries are rendered as a distributed vulnerability field, not as members of either side. Every candidate observation remains connected to its recorded territorial or maritime locale with equal node area.



EDGE SEMANTICS

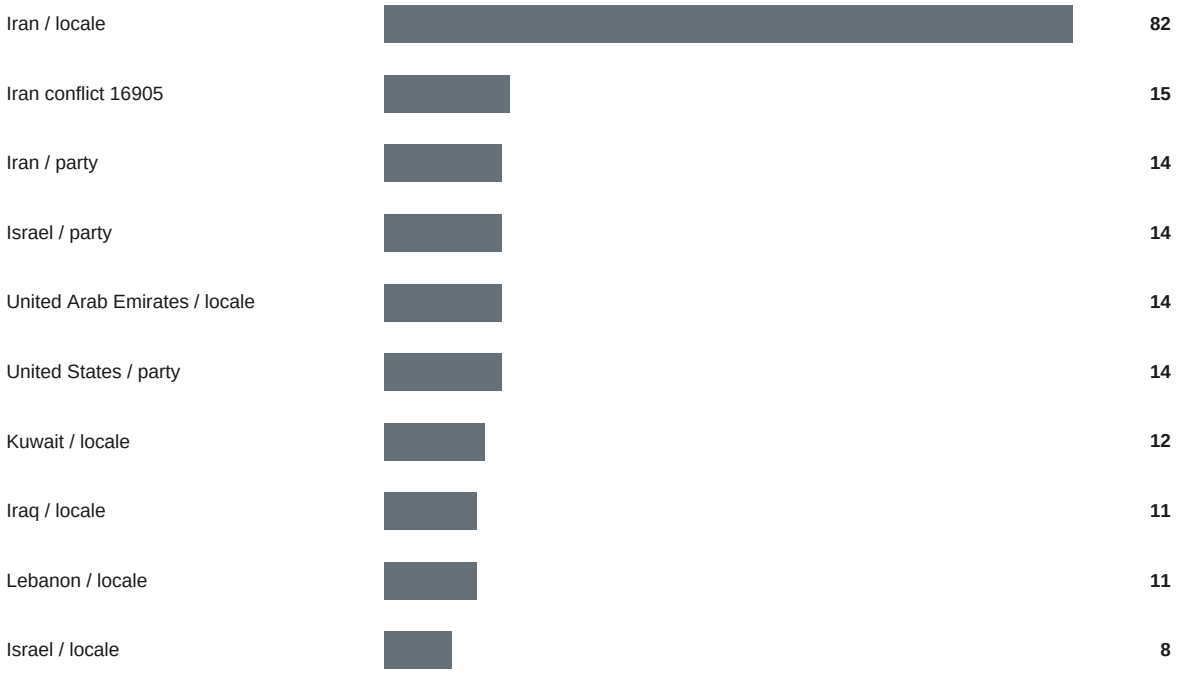
Party-to-locale lines retain the website relation: a side participant belongs to the dyad in which an event is recorded at that locale. They do not assert that every party acted at every location.

BARABASI DIAGNOSTICS

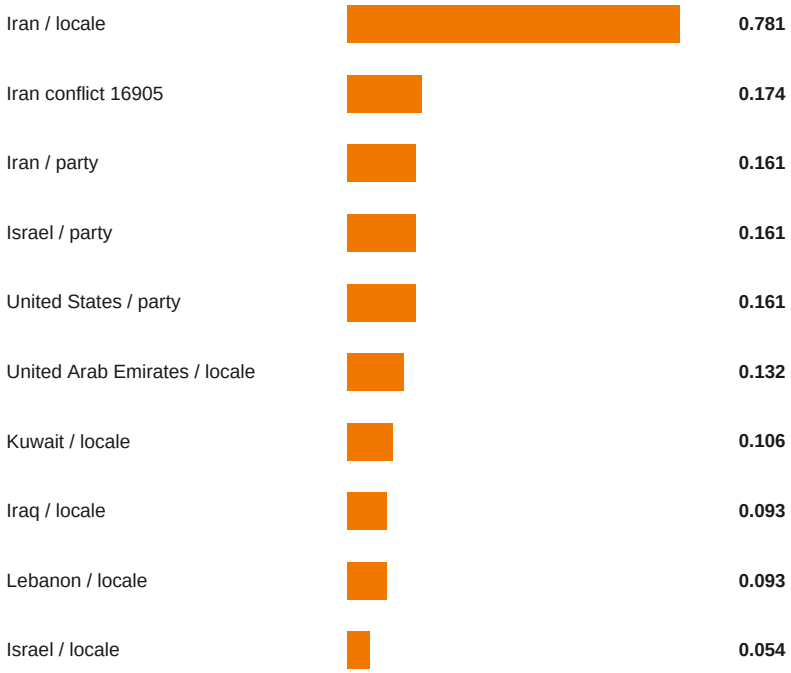
Degree, betweenness, and proportional structure

Topology is calculated on the complete print graph, including all candidate-event leaves. Degree counts direct relations; normalized betweenness measures shortest-path brokerage. Neither statistic is replaced by a narrative assignment.

HIGHEST STRUCTURAL DEGREE



HIGHEST NORMALIZED BETWEENNESS



COMPLETE GRAPH

148 nodes / 186 edges / density 0.0171. Degree distribution: 1:129 / 3:1 / 5:5 / 6:1 / 7:2 / 8:1 / 11:2 / 12:1 / 14:4 / 15:1 / 82:1

Node size in the network: locale nodes follow observation count; observation nodes have equal area; other structural nodes follow degree. Casualty estimates remain inspectable on individual source records and are not aggregated.

PROVENANCE AND OPEN FRONTIER

Sources / snapshots / limits

This proof is generated from repository data. The conflict is current, but the print record is only current through its stated UCDP candidate-event boundary.

UCDP-CANDIDATE	UCDP Candidate Events Dataset, June through August 2026 snapshots ucdp.uu.se	**NATURAL-EARTH**	Natural Earth Admin 0 reference geometry naturalearthdata.com
VDEM	V-Dem Dataset version 16, latest loaded country-year 2025 v-dem.net	**CRS-BASING**	Congressional Research Service R48123: U.S. Overseas Basing congress.gov
IHME	IHME Global Burden of Disease 2023 Results vizhub.healthdata.org	**USAF-IRAN-1979**	U.S. Air Force history: evacuation of U.S. military and support personnel from Iran, 1978-1979 afhistory.af.mil
WORLD-BANK	World Bank World Development Indicators data.worldbank.org	**CIA-IRAN-POSTS**	CIA Reading Room: shutdown of two U.S. electronic listening posts in Iran, 1979 cia.gov

LOADED CANDIDATE LAYER

126 unique candidate observations / 2026-02-28-2026-08-31 / no derived casualty total. Candidate records may overlap. Source snapshots: ucdp-candidate-ged-2026-06: 102; ucdp-candidate-ged-2026-07: 23; ucdp-candidate-ged-2026-08: 1. Coding status: Check: 3; Check deaths: 14; Check dyad: 9; Check geography: 25; Check type of violence: 3; Check vague or biased source: 2; Clear: 70.

REVISION PATH

Regenerate when a new candidate snapshot is deposited. Preserve event IDs, compare revisions, and update the observation boundary. Do not silently carry provisional values to the publication date or convert candidate coding into a final historical record.

GENERATED FROM UCDP CANDIDATE EVENTS, V-DEM, IHME, WORLD BANK / UN, AND NATURAL EARTH